

music festival Rhythm United

BANGALORE Not too many people are aware of the fact that the late Pandit Mallikarjun Mansur, considered one of the doyens of Hindustani classical music, had a close relationship with the Bangalore Kidney Foundation till the time of his death. After a long prolonged stay here, the ailing maestro organised a concert, the proceeds of which he donated entirely to the foundation. The institution has been paying homage to Mansur since then with an annual Hindustani music festival called Dhvani—being held for the past four years. Previous years have seen performances from stalwarts such as Kishori Amonkar, Shubha Mudgal, Shivkumar Sharma, Ronu Majumdar, Gundecha Brothers, Rajan and Sajan Mishra, Rajshekar Mansur and Parmeshwar Hegde. The aim of the concert has been to popularise classical music in south Bangalore and to create awareness about the activities of the foundation, especially their work amongst the poor, in highlighting the

needs of those suffering from kidney ailments and raising funds for programmes such as One Free Dialysis a Day.

This year's festival, titled Fifth Dhvani, will feature musicians from across the country in a series of concerts featuring both vocal and instrumental recitals. The festival will start with a sitar recital by Pandit N.V. Gopinath, followed by a vocal concert by Vidushi Shruti Sadolikar-Katkar. Other musicians who will perform in the much-awaited musical extravaganza include Pandit Samaresh Chowdhury, Pandit Sanjeev Abhyankar, Pandit Jayateerth Mevundi and Pandit Ajay Pohankar. The Pandit Mallikarjun Mansur Award, an annual honour given to a Hindustani music teacher of eminence, forms an important part of this festival. This year the award will be bestowed on the 94-year-old Pandit Datatreya Sadashiv Garud, who has been teaching music for nearly eight decades in Bangalore and in rural Karnataka. On September 20 and 21, at the JSS Auditorium in Jayanagar.

by **Nirmala Ravindran**

MAESTROS BOTH: Pandit Mansur (L) and Pandit Mevundi



VIKRAM SHARMA

art exhibition Rediscovering the Pieces

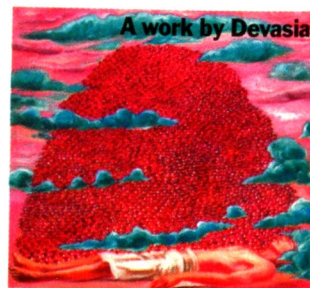
MUMBAI At the age of 86, with his 35th three-city solo exhibition ahead of him, veteran artist Jehangir Sabavala continues to surge ahead with iconic art spanning nearly 60 years. His current collection, *Ricorso*, comprises 20 paintings and took him two and a half years to create. With it, Sabavala's work takes an autobiographical turn, where the artist revisits themes from his earlier work. "I, who has travelled so much in my youth, have grown like a banyan tree. I need my monastic studio to enter my inner realm, to think, and perhaps create something that is fulfilling," writes Sabavala. At times, the recurrent images in his art find space on his new canvases. And despite the recurrence of the old, the new series offers a range of vivid colours and imagery. At Sakshi Gallery from September 27 to October 10. The gallery will also release a comprehensive DVD and CD-ROM on his life and work. by **Swati Mathur**

A work from Sabavala's Purdah series



recommendation Painted Vision

BANGALORE Gallery Sumukha will present *Soul Mountain*, featuring the latest works by Alexander Devasia. The Kerala born and bred artist, who like many others before him went to the M.S. University of Baroda for his post-graduation, speaks of the unknown and unseen in his new work. Devasia does not



hold on to a certain technique, preferring to be a "flowing river, which has to be filtered again and again". On till September 27. by **Nirmala Ravindran**